

# Garema Place Surgery

## AI Policy

Current as of: **July 2026**

### General Practice — Understanding How We Use AI to Improve Your Care

**Garema Place Surgery** uses Artificial Intelligence (AI) to help our doctors provide you with better clinical care. We're committed to being transparent about how we use AI and protecting your privacy every step of the way.

### Clinical AI: Medical Scribes

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#### What Is Clinical AI?

Some of our doctors use **AI-powered medical scribe technology** to help create accurate, comprehensive clinical notes during your consultation.

We currently use an approved AI medical scribe:

#### Lyrebird Health

This tool is designed specifically for healthcare and complies with Australian privacy laws.

#### How It Works

The technology is straightforward:

1. **AI listens quietly** in the background during your appointment
2. **It creates a written transcript** of the clinically relevant information
3. **Your doctor reviews it** carefully and makes corrections if needed
4. **Your doctor approves it** before it's saved to your medical record

Your doctor is always in control. They review every single note before it goes into your medical record, and they remain fully responsible for everything in your file.

#### Why We Use It

This technology gives your doctor a gift: **time to listen to you instead of typing.**

When your doctor isn't watching the computer screen, they can:

- Give you their full attention
- Make better clinical decisions
- Catch important details they might otherwise miss
- Spend more time on your care

### How It Helps You

- **Better focus** – Your doctor listens instead of types
- **More comprehensive notes** – Nothing important gets missed
- **Improved continuity of care** – If you see another doctor or specialist, they have complete information
- **Greater accuracy** – Your medical record is precise and thorough
- **Better diagnosis and treatment** – More detailed notes lead to better clinical decisions

## Privacy and Security: Your Trust Is Everything

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### Your Privacy Is Protected

All AI use at Garema Place Surgery complies with Australian privacy laws, including:

**Privacy Act 1988** (Commonwealth)

### Clinical AI: How Your Data Is Secure

For our medical scribe technology, here's how we protect your information:

- ✓ **Australian processing** – Everything stays in Australia
- ✓ **No audio storage** – Your voice is never kept; audio is deleted immediately after transcription
- ✓ **Sensitive information removed** – Personal details are automatically redacted
- ✓ **Bank-level encryption** – 256-bit encryption (the same standard hospitals use)
- ✓ **Only your doctor can access it** – Your medical record stays confidential
- ✓ **No third-party access** – No one else can see or use your information

## Patient Consent for Clinical AI

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### Your Choice Matters

Using AI medical scribes during your consultation is **completely optional**. Your care will be excellent either way.

### What Informed Consent Means

When we ask for your consent, we want you to understand:

- **What the technology does** – It listens and creates notes that your doctor reviews
- **How your privacy is protected** – Australian processing, encryption, immediate audio deletion
- **That your doctor reviews everything** – Every note is checked and verified by your doctor
- **That it's optional** – You can say yes, no, or change your mind later
- **That your care won't be affected** – Either way, you'll receive the same high-quality care

### How We Get Your Consent

| Tool     | Purpose                                         | Privacy Standard                       |
|----------|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Lyrebird | Creates clinical notes during your consultation | Australia-based, bank-level encryption |

**Consent will be recorded in your file.**

**You can change your mind anytime:** Just let us know, and we'll stop using AI for your notes.

### If You Decline

No problem at all. We'll:

- Respect your decision immediately—no pressure
- Record your choice in your medical record
- Proceed with the consultation using our standard documentation methods
- Continue providing you with excellent care
- Let you know you can change your mind at any future visit

## Our Approved AI Tools

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### Training and Responsibility

#### What Our Doctors Do

Doctors using clinical AI must:

- ✓ Get your informed consent before the consultation where AI is used
- ✓ Review and verify every AI-generated note before saving it
- ✓ Correct any errors or missing information
- ✓ Remain fully responsible for all clinical decisions and your documentation
- ✓ Use only approved AI tools
- ✓ Report any problems immediately

## Your Rights

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#### You Have the Right To:

- **Know when AI is used** – We'll always tell you
- **Ask questions** – About the technology, how it works, or your privacy
- **Consent or refuse** – Without affecting your care
- **Withdraw consent** – At any time, without impacting your care
- **Access your records** – Including any AI-generated notes
- **Request corrections** – If information is inaccurate
- **Raise concerns** – About how we use AI

## Questions or Concerns?

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If you have concerns about how we use AI:

1. **Talk to us first** – Ask your doctor or our reception team
2. **Email** our Practice Manager at [practicemanager@garemaplacsurgery.com.au](mailto:practicemanager@garemaplacsurgery.com.au)
3. **Request our full policy** – We can provide our complete AI Policy from our Policy and Procedure Manual

4. **Contact regulators** – If you'd like to raise concerns externally:

**Health Care Complaints Commission (HCCC NSW):** 1800 043 159

**Office of the Australian Information Commissioner (OAIC):** 1300 363 992

**Fair Work Commission:** 1300 799 675

## Key Takeaways

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- ✓ AI medical scribes help your doctor give you better care
- ✓ Your privacy is protected with medical-grade security
- ✓ Your doctor reviews and approves every note
- ✓ Consenting is completely optional
- ✓ You can change your mind at any time
- ✓ Your care won't be affected by your choice
- ✓ We have formal policies governing how we use AI safely